From the name to the formula in 3 steps

Example: diiron trioxide

1. SPLIT THE TWO WORDS

diiron

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trioxide

→

2. TRANSLATE THE PREFIXES

di + iron = **2 Fe**

tri + oxide = **3 O**

→

3. WRITE IN THE SAME ORDER

first word on the left

$\mathbf{Fe_2O_3}$

To name a compound, read the formula from **left to right**. Fe_2O_3 → **di**iron **tri**oxide. (In Spanish it is read the other way round: trióxido de dihierro.)